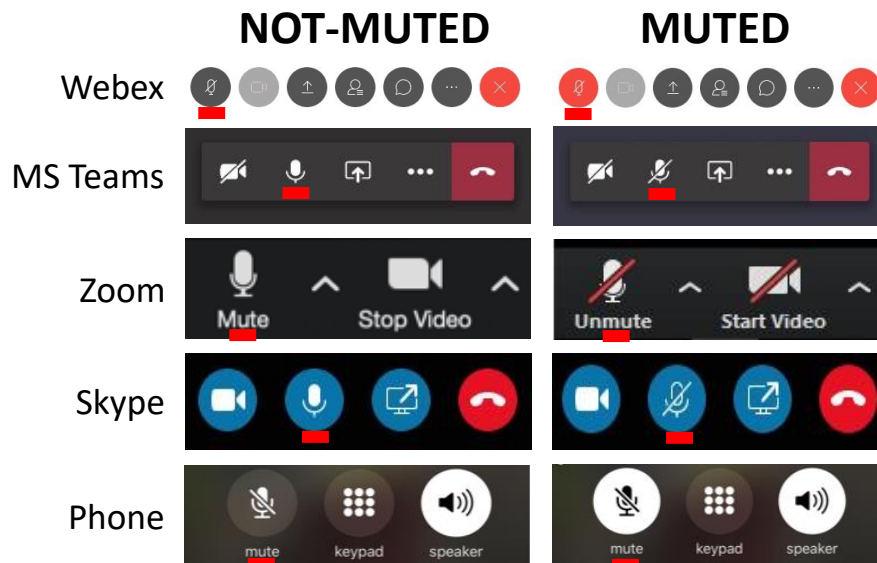


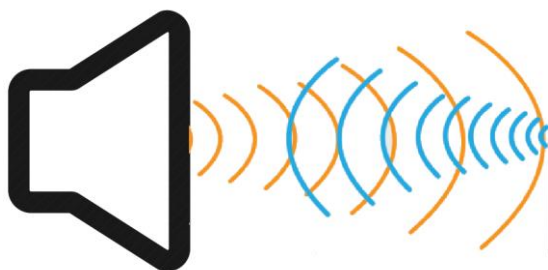
PLEASE MUTE *Unless You're Speaking*



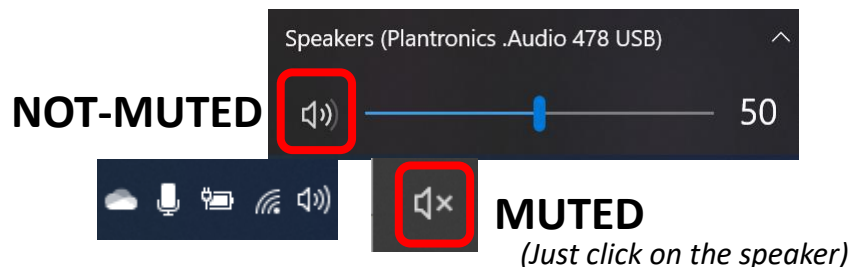
Mute your microphone whenever you're not speaking. Background noise can be an annoying distraction and stifle any meeting's flow.



Hear an ECHO?



If you are dialed in on the phone and not using the Computer Audio, please mute in 2 places – YOUR CONFERENCE PROVIDER AND YOUR COMPUTER.



Environmental Modifications

Gloria Farmer and Linda Ford

Regional Trainers

Office of Waiver and Facility Services

South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services

Environmental Modifications



Environmental Modifications

- This service must be participant-specific and for the benefit of the participant. Environmental modification must be necessary to ensure health, welfare and safety and enable the participant to function with greater independence in the home without which, the participant would require institutionalization.

Environmental Modifications

- The service must be cost-effective. The case manager (CM) must exercise professional judgment regarding the appropriateness of the service.
- The service is not intended for major home improvement, remodeling, or cosmetic improvements. The CM must explore other available community resources prior to requesting approval for this service.

Environmental Modifications

- The need for environmental modifications must be evaluated in the home prior to authorization. The need for this service must be documented in the Home Assessment section of Phoenix. During the home visit, the CM must explain and obtain appropriate signatures on the Landowner Consent Form for all the environmental modification services.
- Exception: Authorization of fans or air conditioners does not require a Landowner Consent Form.

Environmental Modifications

- The CM will update the service plan to include the need for environmental modification.
- Prior approval must be requested via the service request section of the service plan in Phoenix.
- **Note:** There is a lifetime cap of **\$7,500**. This includes the costs for ramps and enhanced environmental modifications. Requests to exceed this amount must be sent to the South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services (SCDHHS) Central Office for consideration and approval.

Environmental Modifications

Service Provider Report

- Prior to authorizing services, a participant, responsible party, and/or authorized representative must make a choice of provider for each waiver service.
 - Air Conditioner
 - Fan
 - Ramp

Environmental Modifications

Service Provider Report

- The CM will create the Service Provider Report (Provider Choice Form) located in Phoenix under the Service Authorization section.
- The CM will obtain provider choice(s) from the primary contact in order of preference.

Environmental Modifications

Service Provider Report

- These choices may be obtained verbally, by mail or during an in-home visit. If the choices are made verbally, the CM will document the choices in the narrative, in the order of preference.
- The primary contact should be encouraged to contact chosen provider(s) to determine if the provider is willing to accept the referral and to determine how long it will take the provider to complete the work.

Environmental Modifications

Service Provider Report

- Under no circumstances shall a CM assist the participant in choosing a provider.



Environmental Modifications

Fans/Air Conditioners

- 1 Fan
- 1 Air Conditioner
- Can be authorized based on medical need.
- The CM will update the service plan to include the need for fan/air conditioner equipment.

Environmental Modifications

Fans/Air Conditioners

- The Landowner Consent Form is not required for this service. The CM will update the service plan to include the need for fan/air conditioner equipment.
- Prior approval must be requested via the service request section of the service plan in Phoenix.
- **Service Justification:** Emphasize need based on health and safety related issues. Include date last item was received.

Environmental Modifications

Air Conditioners

- Air conditioners must be 10,000 BTU. The established rate includes installation and a one-year in-home warranty. During this one-year warranty period, it is the responsibility of the provider to replace and/or repair the unit.



Environmental Modifications

Fans

- Box fans must have three (3) speeds.



Environmental Modifications

Fans/Air Conditioners

- The CM must verify service and satisfaction with the work completed by the provider, as appropriate, on the next scheduled contact after the authorization end date.
- If there are problems, the CM shall negotiate resolution of the problems and/or complaint with the provider.

Environmental Modifications - Ramps



Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- The need for this service must be evaluated in the home prior to authorizing the service.
- The CM will visit the participant's home to assess the need for a ramp.
- This visit may be completed at the next regularly scheduled home visit unless there is a critical need requiring an earlier visit.



Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- During the home visit, the CM must explain and obtain appropriate signatures on the Landowner Consent Form. The consent form signature is to be obtained in Phoenix.
- If a hard copy form is used, the signed form must be scanned into Phoenix under the environmental modification scan tag.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- Homeowner/Family Member Consent Form:

Create Participant Homeowner/Family Member Homeowner Consent Form

Above participant owns his/her own home located at the above address or participant's home is owned by family member who does not charge a rental fee to participant.

Above participant has a need for Environmental Modification or Enhanced Environmental Modification to the above address. The service must be cost effective. The service is not intended for major home improvement, remodeling, or cosmetic enhancement.

It has been determined that the above participant can benefit from the following modification(s) to the above street address. (Environmental Specialist may also recommend other modifications.)

Ramp:

☐

Wedge:

☐

Handrail to outside existing structure:

☐

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- Landowner's Consent Form:

The above participant has a need for Environmental Modification to the above residence. The service must be cost effective. The service is not intended for major home improvement, remodeling, or cosmetic enhancement.

It has been determined that the above participant's residence can benefit from the following modification(s).

Ramp: ☐

Wedge: ☐

Handrail to outside existing structure: ☐

Landowner's Name:

Landowner's Address:

Create Form

Cancel



Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- The CM will obtain provider choice.
- The need for this service must be documented in the Home Assessment section of Phoenix.
- The CM will update the service plan to include the need for a ramp.
- Obtain prior approval.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

Service justification for ramps and enhanced modification should include the following:

Service Justification: State need based on mobility, accessibility, and/or health and safety issues. State homeowner consent was signed, and the document is in forms or has been scanned. Include amount currently spent to date towards lifetime cap.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- Only **one ramp** may be authorized at a time for a participant.
- If a participant changes location and requests a new ramp or a participant's current ramp is deemed unsafe, the CM may make a home visit to assess need.
- An additional ramp may be approved if the participant has changed locations and has not exceeded the \$7500 lifetime cap.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- When the ramp is completed, the provider must submit the Ramp Completion Form in Phoenix. Upon notification of receipt of the Ramp Completion Form via Phoenix, the CM must complete the Service Provision Form.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- The start date is the date the Service Provision Form is created, and the end date is **thirty (30) days** later. The dollar amount to be entered on the Service Provision Form is the dollar amount indicated by the provider via the Ramp Completion Form.

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- If there are issues with the ramp/environmental modification, the CM will proceed with creating and sending the Service Provision Form to the provider while the Environmental Modification Specialist is reviewing the complaint.

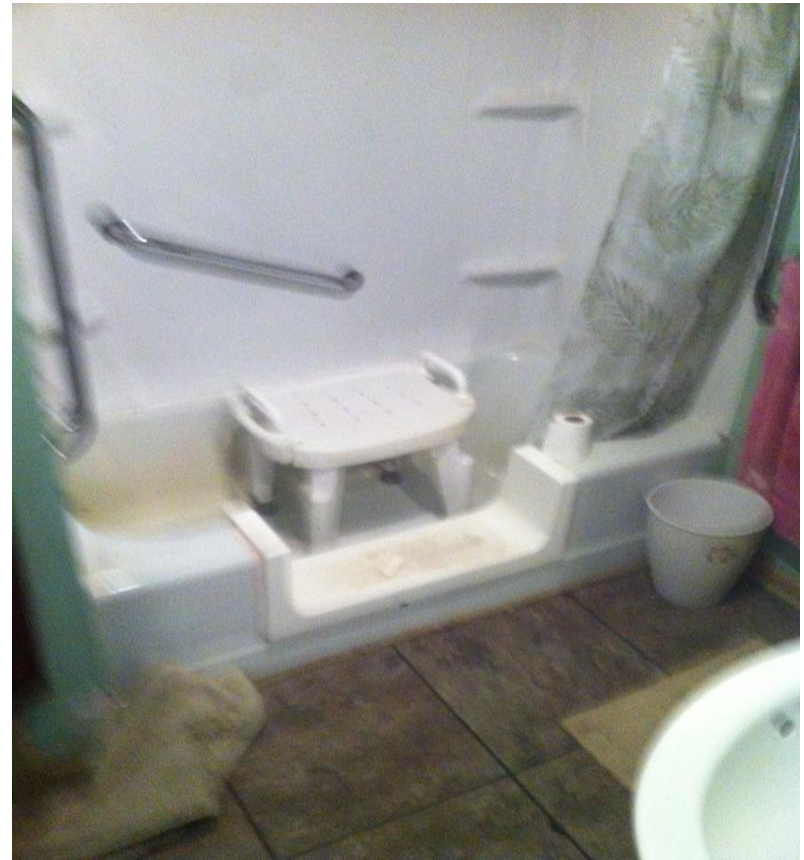
***Provider payment should not be delayed pending review by the Environmental Modification Specialist.**

Environmental Modifications

Ramps

- Participants are responsible for ramp maintenance.
- The CM may request ramp inspection by the Environmental Modification Specialist if a ramp is deemed unsafe or the structure is compromised.
- The Environmental Modification Specialist will determine whether to approve ramp repair or replacement.
- **The cost of ramps service is included in the \$7,500 lifetime cap for environmental modification services.**

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps



Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- If a participant requires a ramp and enhanced environmental modification, the CM must follow the same policy as outlined for ramps with some exceptions.



Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- Prior approval for the environmental modification and the ramp must be requested separately in the service request section of the service plan in Phoenix.
- Prior approval is required prior to sending the request to the **Environmental Modification Specialist via Phoenix.**

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- Complete the Environmental Needs tab of the Home Assessment section in Phoenix.
- Complete the ramp form in the Home Assessment section in Phoenix.
- Indicate the type of enhanced environmental modification needed from the list in Phoenix.
- Send the request to the Environmental Modification Specialist via Phoenix.
- Wait for a response from the Environmental Modification Specialist through Phoenix before proceeding.

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- The Environmental Modification Specialist will assess the request and indicate via Phoenix when the request is ready for bidding.



- **Note:** If there is a critical need for the ramp and the participant cannot wait for the bid process for the enhanced environmental modification, the CM will authorize the ramp in accordance with the participant's choice of provider and follow the process for the ramp service.



Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

Environmental Modification Provider Bidding Process

The providers serving the geographical area of the participant will:

- Receive an email from the Environmental Modification Specialist and Phoenix notification inviting them to bid on the enhanced environmental modification.
- Access the details of the job including location and pictures in Phoenix.
- Submit a bid via Phoenix within one week.
- **Once the bid period is closed, the Environmental Modification Specialist will award the job by notifying the winning bidder and the CM via Phoenix.**

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- The CM must click on the notification to see the enhanced environmental modification project screen where the awarded bid dollar amount is shown.
- If the bid indicates the winning environmental modification provider must build the ramp, the CM will **send a ramp referral to the winning environmental modification** provider.
- If the bid does not indicate the winning environmental modification provider must build the ramp, the CM will send a ramp referral to the ramp providers of **participant's choice**, in the order of preference.

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

Service Authorization for Environmental Modification

- The enhanced environmental modification provider indicates via Phoenix when the project(s) is completed.
- The CM will:
 - Click on the notification to see the enhanced environmental modification project screen where the awarded bid dollar amount is shown.
 - Click “Create Authorization.” Create a Service Provision Form for the environmental modification. **The start date will be the date of the Service Provision Form is created and the end date will be thirty (30) days later.**

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

Service Authorization for Ramp

- When the ramp is completed, the provider must submit the Ramp Completion Form in Phoenix.
- The CM will:
 - Click on the notification of receipt of the Ramp Completion Form via Phoenix;
 - Click “Create Authorization”. Complete a Service Provision Form for the ramp. **The start date is the date the Service Provision Form is created, and the end date is thirty (30) days later.**

Enhanced Environmental Modification and Ramps

- The dollar amount of the Service Provision Form is the amount indicated by the provider via the Ramp Completion Form. The provider will bill through Care Call.
- If the participant and/or primary contact is dissatisfied or complains about the ramp or Enhanced Modification, an inspection by the Environmental Modification Specialist is needed, the CM will email Provider-Distribution@scdhhs.gov to request an inspection.

Questions?

